Annex AM

Environment, Health & Safety (EHS)

UNIVERSITY HEALTH, SAFETY AND ENVIORNMENT POLICY

Guidelines and Standard Operating Procedures

NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCES AND TECHNOLOGY

Message from the Rector

NUST, as the premier higher education institution of Pakistan, is a major domestic engine of promoting nation-building, societal advancement, and economic development. We aim to provide an environment conducive to the pursuit of excellence in learning, research, entrepreneurship, and innovation on a non-discriminatory basis.

Knowledge acquisition, dissemination, and production at NUST presupposes a diverse range of activities. These activities daily bring together a diverse range of people in varying roles in constant interaction with each other and with the environment, both built and natural. This necessarily entails some degree of risk because risk is inherent in the very nature of our existence in the world. While we can never eliminate risk completely, we can certainly work to reduce it.

NUST is committed to providing a healthy and safe environment in pursuance of its mission. We make every realistic effort to ensure the health and safety of faculty, students, staff, and visitors. However, risk reduction, through a mature awareness of health and safety in our professional and personal routines, is both an individual and a collective responsibility. This responsibility brooks no delegation.

For most, NUST is a place of study and work; for some, it is also a home. We, therefore, expect all of us to be always mindful of our shared responsibility to preserve our own safety and that of others, whether we are studying, working, or living here.

We should constantly endeavour toward this common goal. Together, we aim to achieve this goal by means of the maintenance of proactive, real-time health and safety implementation, characterized by mutual trust, continuous improvement, open communication, collective ownership, and conscientious leadership.

1. Purpose

The purpose of this document is to provide health and safety guidelines for university premises and construction projects.

2. Aim

The university is committed to achieving a zero-incident environment where staff, students, residents and visitors of the university can perform their functions and daily life activities within a safe and healthy environment. The aim of these guidelines is to minimize the risks to health and safety of people related to and surrounding the university.

3. Objectives

To achieve the aim of the health and safety guidelines, the following objectives have been defined.

a. Ensure the safety of construction sites within the premises of the university by following the safety precautions and use of avoidance measures.
b. Put measures in place for safe evacuation and swift reporting of fire incidents.
c. Enable a healthy and safe environment for sports by observing a set of precautions.
d. Prevention of unauthorized access to lake area and surroundings and ensure timely response in case of drowning.
e. Making sure that the traffic rules are observed for avoidance of accidents.
f. Provide guidance for first responders.

4. Scope

The scope of these guidelines covers all staff, students, residents, contractors, and visitors in all campuses of the university.

5. Guidelines

Health and safety guidelines in the light of the defined objectives are listed in areas of construction, fire, sports, lake, road safety and medical responders.

a. Construction Safety

i. Safe access to and around the site for people and vehicles should be ensured.

ii. The construction work site should be properly fenced, and suitable signs should be posted around the site.

iii. Night-time and weekend protection is put in place, as required, before the site is closed.

iv. Access to heavy construction machinery such as excavators, bulldozers, compactors, cranes, tower-cranes etc. should be restricted.

v. Access to stairs should be restricted by closing its entrance after working hours.

vi. Footpaths should be leveled and firm and material must not be stored on passages.

vii. Designated storage areas for plants, materials, waste, and flammable substances should be used.

viii. Flammable materials should be stored away from other materials and protected from accidental ignition.

ix. Every part of the site should be well lit naturally or artificially.

x. People working at the site should use proper safety gear including belts, helmets, etc.

xi. The public must be adequately protected from any work created hazards, such as excavation.

xii. Appropriate warnings, signs, warning lights and instructional safety signs should be conspicuously posted and placed where necessary.

xiii. The public must also be protected from falling debris and objects from the project site.

xiv. Adequate means to protect against wind-blown debris and construction-related materials should be ensured.

xv. All sewerage and water tanks should be covered appropriately.

b. Fire Safety

i. Enough fire extinguishers should be installed in buildings.
ii. Periodic inspection of fire extinguishers should be carried out regularly.
iii. Fire Marshalls should be nominated for each floor of the building.
iv. Regular fire drills should be conducted on the campus.
v. Assembly areas should be properly marked outside the buildings.
vi. Installation of fire alarms and suppression system should be ensured in the buildings.
vii. Fire points should be properly maintained.
viii. Staff and students should be trained to deal with fires.
ix. Emergency numbers must be displayed at visible places in a clear manner to ensure communication in case of fire.
x. Exit signs should be placed in buildings at visible places.
xi. Evacuation plans should be displayed on notice boards and in offices.
xii. Multiple passages should be provided to evacuate buildings in case of fire.

c. Sports Safety

i. Use of sport facilities such as horse-riding, swimming pool and gym should only be allowed in the presence of trained instructors.
ii. Wearing safety gear should be mandatory before riding, swimming, and exercising.
iii. Safety instructions should be displayed in the gym, riding club and swimming pool.
iv. Only kids of appropriate age should be allowed in sports facilities.

d. Lake Safety

i. Areas around lake needs to be clearly sign posted.
ii. Areas around the lake should be properly lit at night.

iii. Dangerous waterfront areas should be clearly marked and access to the lake should be restricted and controlled.

iv. A single person should not be allowed to be in a lake area. Always allow at least two people

v. Communication devices should be located at prominent and easily accessible locations around the lake to contact emergency services.

vi. Emergency lifesaving equipment such as life boats should be made available near the lake.

vii. Colony children and parents should be given periodic awareness through workshops about the dangers of water and how to ask for help in case of emergency.

e. Road Safety

i. Ensure a speed limit of 40 km/h is complied with by all vehicles on the campus, even after closing hours.

ii. Wrong parking should be checked and fined.

iii. Motorcycles should be provided to supervising staff with communication sets to ensure road safety and other security aspects round the clock.

iv. Any violation of the given SOP or instructions should be immediately reported.

f. Medical Responders

i. Place helpline / rescue number on visible places throughout the campus.

ii. Paramedical staff should be trained in essential first aid services such as CPR, wound handling, dog / snake bite, etc.

iii. Regular training of CPR should be arranged for university staff.

iv. First responders among the paramedical staff should be identified.

v. Snake bite and rabies vaccines should be readily available in the campus.

vi. Stray dogs may be captured and sent to dog shelters.

6. Standard Operation Procedures (SOPs)

In addition to the general health and safety guidelines given in previous sections, detailed standard operating procedures have also been prepared for critical health, safety and environmental (HSE) functions that are attached as annexures to this document. The details of these procedures are as follows.

S No	Title of SOP	Responsible Dte / School	Annexure
1	Fire Safety	Adm Dte	A
2	Road Safety	Adm Dte	B
3	Waste Management (Chemicals)	ASAB	C
4	Psychological Health	C3A	D
5	Labs Safety	SCME	E
6	Chemicals Safety	SCME	F
7	Electricity Safety	SEECS	G
8	Infrastructure Developments / Constructions Works Safety	SCEE	H
9	Residential Area Safety	SINES	I
10	Sports Safety	Field Adm Dte	J
11	Medical and Health	NMC / Field Adm Dte	K

7. Conclusion

A comprehensive policy document for tackling the challenges related to HSE has been developed by NUST and the policies and procedures laid out in the document are implemented through respective Directorates / Institutes / Schools of NUST.